Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — State intervention in the family

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 5 · Chapter State intervention in the family

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The family is a social institution shaped by personal relationships, culture, economic conditions and law. State intervention can protect members who lack equal bargaining power.

1. Intervention may address domestic violence, child protection, education, inheritance, marriage, maintenance and equal treatment under law.

2. Arguments for restraint emphasise privacy, autonomy, cultural diversity and the risk of excessive state control.

3. Arguments for intervention stress that a purely private sphere can conceal coercion, abuse and unequal power. Rights and safety may require legal protection.

4. A defensible approach balances autonomy and pluralism with equal citizenship, protection from violence, children's interests and due process.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?